



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

National Police College of Jamaica Occupational Health and Safety Policy

Title: NPCJ Occupational Health and Safety Policy and Standard Operating Procedures	Identification Code: JCF/NPCJ/PL/SFs/0009/2022
Effective Date: 2025-Apr-30	Pages: 11
Review Date: 2025-Apr-25	Distribution: Training Branch
Revision #2	Process Owners: ACP NPCJ
Rescinds: 2024-May-08; 2021-Mar-01	
Authors: NPCJ	Owner: JCF
First Published: 2022-Mar-01	Review: Triennially

1.0 Introduction

The National Police College of Jamaica is located on 700 acres in Twickenham Park, St. Catherine. It is approximately 1.6 km east of Spanish Town, the old capital of Jamaica and is 20 km west of Kingston, the present capital. The College shares facilities with the Caribbean Regional Drug Law Enforcement Training Centre (REDTRAC), the Major Organised Crime and Anti-Corruption Agency (MOCA) and the Medical Services Branch (MSB). The compound with all its personnel and assets is vulnerable to many hazards and threats, and in cases of any form of emergency or disaster affecting the National Police College of Jamaica, the College will respond to the same as outlined in this policy.

2.0 Purpose

The National Police College of Jamaica is committed to providing a safe and healthy working and learning environment to all members of staff and students. The College and its employees aim to construct every structure plan, every activity and perform all tasks in a manner that minimizes risks, promotes the health, safety and wellbeing of all individuals, and prevents occupational injuries or illnesses. Health and safety is a joint responsibility shared by all members of the NPCJ community. This policy applies to all employees, students, and visitors of the NPCJ.

3.0 Scope

The NPCJ Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Policy encapsulates what is needed to ensure the safety of all personnel who visit and utilise the compound. This includes all members of staff from all the various entities on the compound, Students/Trainees/Course participants and visitors. The policy also provides standard operating procedures that are to be consistently followed, and those initiated in the event of an atypical event that may jeopardise the health and safety of persons on the compound.

4.0 Policy Statements

It is the policy of the NPCJ to:

- 4.1.1 Maintain and promote a safe and healthy working and learning environment for NPCJ administrators, supervisors, and other individuals who direct the work of others and are responsible for the health and safety of all individuals under their direction and the workplaces under their charge.
- 4.1.2 Implement all the necessary measures and programs to eliminate or control potential health and safety hazards associated with the activities under their supervision.
- 4.1.3 Ensure employees receive health and safety training and education appropriate to their job requirements.
- 4.1.4 Ensure all employees, contractors, tenants, students and visitors comply with all relevant legislation and all NPCJ policies and procedures regarding health and safety.
- 4.1.5 Ensure every employee uses safe work practices on all assignments, as governed by NPCJ policies and procedures. Employees are responsible for reporting unsafe conditions and workplace injuries to their supervisors.
- 4.1.6 Ensure that all other policies and operating procedures meet the goals of this Policy

5.0 Interpretation/Definitions

C-TOC	Counter-Terrorism Organised Crime Branch
EMT	Emergency Medical Team
EPA	Environmental Protection Agency
FLPD	Faculty of Leadership and Professional Development
FOMST	Faculty of Operations Management and Skills Training
FRPT	Faculty of Recruit and Probationer Training
GOJ	Government of Jamaica
ICTD	Information Communication and Technology Division
JCF	Jamaica Constabulary Force
MOCA	Major Organised Crime and Anti-Corruption Agency
MOH	Ministry of Health
MOU	Memorandum of Understanding
MSB	Medical Services Branch
NOAA	National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration
NPCJ	National Police College of Jamaica
OHS	Occupational Health and Safety
PMLD	Property Management and Logistics Department
PPE	Personal Protective Equipment
REDTRAC	Regional Drug Law Enforcement Training Centre

6.0 Responsibilities

The following summarises critical responsibilities.

6.1 Director, Assistant Commissioner of Police in charge of Training Branch/Director NPCJ has the responsibility to:

- 6.1.1 Ensure hazards are identified, assessed and controlled.
- 6.1.2 Ensure staff receive information, training and supervision to ensure work practices are safe and without health risk.
- 6.1.3 Investigate all incidents and accidents, and ensure preventative measures are implemented and monitored.
- 6.1.4 Take prompt remedial action to eliminate any unsafe or unhealthy conditions or behaviour.
- 6.1.5 Implement the OHS Policy and Standard Operating Procedures, effectively.

6.2 The Academic Board (the Board) shall:

- 6.2.1 Ensure that the OHS Policy is continually updated.
- 6.2.2 Ensure that a comprehensive risk management system is developed and adhered to.
- 6.2.3 Consulting with stakeholders on OHS matters.

6.3 Faculty and Department Heads shall:

- 6.3.1 Arrange OHS inspections, rectifying deficiencies and maintaining records.
- 6.3.2 Train staff in correct OHS procedures.
- 6.3.3 The development of new and improved procedures.
- 6.3.4 Employees are responsible and accountable for:
- 6.3.5 Cooperate with OHS Policy and Procedures.
- 6.3.6 Work in accordance with agreed safe work procedures.
- 6.3.7 Report all incidents and hazards.

6.4 The Ministry of National Security shall

- 6.4.1 ensure the health, safety and welfare of all employees. This involves the employer provision of:
 - a) Safety equipment
 - b) Safe places of work
 - c) Information
 - d) Instruction and training
 - e) Supervision

- f) Effective office attending and property maintenance

6.5 All Members of Staff shall:

- 6.5.1 Take care of the health and safety of themselves and others at work
- 6.5.2 Cooperate with the employer on health and safety
- 6.5.3 Wear personal protective equipment where provided
- 6.5.4 Not willfully or recklessly interfering with workplace safety
- 6.5.5 Not place other employees or other people at risk in the workplace
- 6.5.6 Not willfully injuring himself/herself
- 6.5.7 Attend training as offered and follow safe work practices

7.0 Standard Operating Procedures

7.1. Medical Health Emergencies (Infectious Diseases – Epidemics or Pandemics)

7.1.1 In all cases, the National Police College will follow the Government of Jamaica's Ministry of Health Department Guidelines. Notwithstanding, the College's operational decisions should be based on the level of disease transmission in the community and its readiness to protect the safety and health of its staff, students and customers. This should include activities to:

- a. Prevent and reduce transmission among staff and students,
- b. Maintain healthy college operations and a healthy work environment.

7.1.2 The above will be accomplished by adopting the following guidelines

- a. To prevent and reduce transmission among staff and students.
- b. Actively encourage sick employees to stay home.
- c. Staff members that have symptoms should notify their supervisor and stay home.
- d. Sick members should follow the guidelines as instructed by the Jamaica Constabulary Force policies and the MOH. Staff and students should not return to the College until the criteria to discontinue home isolation are met, under the advice and instructions of the MOH.
- e. Staff who are well but who have a sick family member at home with an infectious disease should notify their supervisor and follow the recommended MOH precautions.
- f. Implement daily in-person or virtual health checks (e.g., symptoms and/or temperature screening) of staff before they enter the facility, in accordance with the MOH guidelines.
- g. Separate sick staff/students. Staff who appear to have symptoms upon arrival at work or who become ill during the day should immediately

be separated from other staff members, students, customers, and visitors, and sent to the Medical Services Branch for assessment before being sent home.

- h. A vehicle should be available to safely transport a staff member or student who becomes sick while at work or on campus to the nearest health centre or hospital.
- i. If isolation is required, all protocols issued by the MOH and GOJ should be adhered to. All staff members shall follow the MOH cleaning and disinfection recommendations to avoid the spread of these diseases.
- j. To maintain healthy operations, the following shall be adhered to by all staff members and students:
 - i. Identify where and how staff and students might be exposed to infectious diseases.
 - ii. Conduct a thorough workplace hazard assessment to identify potential workplace hazards related to infectious diseases.
 - iii. Use appropriate combinations of controls to limit the spread of any infectious disease, including engineering controls, workplace administrative policies, and personal protective equipment (PPE) to protect workers from the identified hazards (if required).
 - iv. When possible, avoid using other staff members' phones, desks, offices, or other work tools and equipment. Clean and disinfect them before and after use.
 - v. Close or limit access to common areas where staff or students will likely congregate and interact.

7.2 Fires

7.2.1 Fire Prevention and Readiness

- a. Preventing fires begins with awareness and accountability and adherence to the Jamaica Fire Code.
- b. All members of the NPCJ community are expected to contribute to a fire-safe environment. This means avoiding unsafe practices such as blocking fire exits, leaving electrical equipment unattended, or using open flames without authorisation. Flammable materials must be stored securely and only used in designated areas.
- c. To support these efforts, the NPCJ ensures that each building is equipped with extinguishers and emergency lighting, which the Property Management and Logistics Department team routinely inspects.
- d. Fire exit routes are marked, and evacuation maps are posted strategically throughout each building.
- e. Additionally, all students and staff must participate in fire drills at least

twice yearly. These drills simulate real conditions and allow individuals to practice using exits, moving in groups, and responding to instructions.

7.2.2 In the Event of a Fire

- a. If a fire breaks out, the first person to discover it must activate the fire extinguisher, if it is safe. They should also call the Fire Brigade – 110 emergency number and ensure an alert is communicated to senior officers via the JCF Base Radio. Once the above has been initiated, an orderly evacuation must begin immediately.
- b. All individuals must leave the area using the closest designated emergency exit. Doors should be closed (not locked) to contain smoke and flames. Faculty members and safety monitors should ensure classrooms and offices are cleared before exiting, providing special assistance to those who need it.
- c. Everyone must proceed directly to their assigned assembly point. Safety Monitors will conduct roll calls and report missing person(s). No one should re-enter the building until it has been declared safe by the Fire Brigade.

7.2.3 Post-Evacuation and Recovery

- a. Once the immediate threat has been managed:
- b. A headcount will be completed to account for all persons.
- c. Medical personnel will assess injuries, and emotional or psychological support may be arranged through the college's wellness services.
- d. The Officer in charge of the Property Management and Logistics Department must complete an incident report and submit it to the Office of the Assistant Commissioner of Police in charge of Training. Branch/Director of NPCJ **within 24 hours**.

7.2.4 Fire Extinguishers

- a. The fire extinguishers around the campus have been strategically placed by potential hazard, size, and type.
- b. In most cases, fire extinguishers are located next to the main door of a room, near an exit door (e.g., a stairwell) or every 50' – 75' in the corridor of a building, depending on the criteria of the Building Code.
- c. The following outlines the procedures for the inspection of fire extinguishers
- d. The appropriate fire extinguisher type must match the purpose and size of the room being housed.
- e. Fire extinguishers must be inspected twice per year according to the following:
 - a) Activate the - Rescue and First Aid Procedures
 - b) The inspection tag, plastic tie, and pin should be in place

- c) Does the pressure gauge needle point straight up, indicating fully charged?

7.3 Hurricane and Flooding

7.3.1 Hurricane Preparation and Readiness

- a. Preparation begins at the start of each hurricane season with the Force-wide publication of the Hurricane Standing Orders.
- b. As the season progresses inspections of the campus infrastructure are done to have trees near important structures such as the deep well, generator, microwave antenna, IT network cables, and key administrative buildings are trimmed to prevent damage from falling branches.
- c. The hurricane preparedness plan follows a phased approach aligned with national guidelines:
 - i. **Phase 1 (48 hours before impact – Early Hurricane Alert):**
All movable items are secured. The deep well, generator, and antenna are checked, and vehicles are relocated to safe zones. Emergency teams are placed on alert, and contact lists are verified.
 - ii. **Phase 2 (24 hours before impact – Hurricane Alert):**
Departments secure critical documents, equipment, and electronic records. Emergency supplies are audited and ready.
 - iii. **Phase 3 (12 hours before impact – Hurricane Warning):**
Final walkthroughs are conducted. All last-minute risks are mitigated. Vehicles are covered or moved to reinforced areas. Essential staff remain on standby.
 - iv. **Phase 4 (6 hours or less before impact – Hurricane Watch):**
All final lockdown measures are completed. Emergency communications are activated, and the campus transitions to full emergency mode.
- d. During the hurricane, all persons must remain indoors in pre-identified safe locations.
- e. After the hurricane passes, members of PMLD will immediately conduct a structured damage assessment. The assessment includes checking for injuries, damage to buildings, water supply infrastructure, IT systems, and the condition of the College's vehicle fleet.
- f. Within 48 hours, a full management review with the Assistant Commissioner of Police in charge of Training is held to coordinate recovery efforts, prioritise urgent repairs, and restore essential services.

7.3.2 Flooding Preparation and Readiness

- a. Prior to the rainy season, the College conducts a full inspection of all

drainage systems, removing blockages and ensuring that proper water runoff channels are clear.

- b. Low-lying areas and flood-prone sections of the campus are assessed, and measures are taken to elevate critical equipment, protect electrical installations, and maintain stockpiles of emergency sandbags and portable water pumps.
- c. During the issuance of a flood warning, the College will:
 - i. Monitor weather bulletins and flood warnings from ODPEM and the Meteorological Service of Jamaica.
 - ii. Relocate vehicles and movable equipment to higher ground.
 - iii. Turn off electrical systems at risk of submersion.
 - iv. Evacuate buildings in low-lying or flood-threatened areas.
 - v. Shelter at designated safe zones on campus if external evacuation isn't possible.
- d. Within 48 hours, a full inspection for water damage, electrical hazards, and structural integrity will be conducted. Professional cleanup and sanitation teams will be organised to hasten the restoration of essential services progressively based on risk assessments.

7.3.3 Earthquake Preparation and Readiness

- i. NPCJ emphasises training and drills through biennial earthquake drills, ensuring all staff and students know instinctively to "Drop, Cover, and Hold On" during a tremor.
- ii. In an earthquake, individuals must immediately drop to the ground, seek cover under sturdy furniture or near structural walls, and hold on until the shaking ceases.
- iii. Upon stabilization, evacuees leave buildings cautiously and proceed to assembly points away from buildings, trees, and power lines.
- iv. Post-earthquake actions include rapid damage assessments of buildings, utilities, and communications systems.
- v. Rescue and first aid operations are prioritised, followed by structural assessments to determine when it is safe to reoccupy facilities.
- vi. Reports of damages and incidents are escalated through the PMLD to the Assistant Commissioner of Police and then to the Deputy Commissioner of Police in charge of the Administration and Support Services Portfolio.

7.3.4 Suspicious Packages

- i. If a suspicious package is found, no attempt should be made to move or open it. The immediate area must be evacuated, the campus security contacted, and law enforcement notified.
- ii. Trained emergency personnel from the Technical Services Division will

assess and handle the situation.

- iii. Quick evacuation and adherence to instructions are vital to ensuring the safety of all campus occupants.

7.2.5 Cyber/Technological Attacks Preparation and Readiness

- i. NPCJ acknowledges that cyber threats can severely disrupt educational and administrative functions. Therefore, the NPCJ will:
- ii. Maintain strong firewall and antivirus protections on all networks.
- iii. Conduct regular cybersecurity audits and vulnerability assessments.
- iv. Require complex passwords, two-factor authentication, and secure data storage practices.
- v. Train staff and students to detect phishing attempts and suspicious online behaviour.
- vi. In the event of a cyberattack, suspicious system behaviour must be reported immediately to the IT Security Unit. Systems showing signs of compromise must be isolated.
- vii. Prompt reporting, containment, and investigation should be employed to minimise damage, protect sensitive information, and maintain the continuity of College operations.

7.2.6 Terrorism Threats Preparation and Readiness

- i. The potential for terrorism, though rare, demands constant vigilance. Therefore, the NPCJ actively cooperates with other law enforcement agencies within the Ministry of National Security and the Jamaica Constabulary Force, such as MOCA and C-TOC, to detect and respond to threats.
- ii. If a terrorism threat is received or suspected, immediate actions include contacting law enforcement, activating campus lockdown protocols, and securing vulnerable areas.
- iii. Staff and students should be trained to recognise suspicious behaviour and act swiftly.
- iv. Post-incident assessments continually improve security measures to protect the NPCJ community.

7.2.7 Civil Unrest Preparation and Readiness

- i. Civil unrest preparedness includes constant monitoring of potential threats, secure lockdown procedures, and coordinated response plans with local police.
- ii. During unrest, access to the NPCJ may be restricted, and students and staff may be instructed to shelter in place.
- iii. Maintaining calm, following communication updates, and cooperating fully with security personnel ensures that order is preserved and risks are minimised

8.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

The NPCJ Occupational Health and Safety Policy and Standard Operating Procedures shall be read in conjunction with the Jamaica Occupational Safety and Health Act, the NPCJ Operational Continuity Policy and Standard Operating Procedures, JCF Hurricane Standing Orders and the Jamaica Fire Code.